NOTE This is only an example of what a structured log could look like. The format used for the logs will vary depending on the logging provider used and could be anything. The main point is that properties of the log are available as key-value pairs.

Adding structured logging to your app requires a logging provider that can create and store structured logs. Elasticsearch is a popular general search and analytics engine that can be used to store and query your logs. One big advantage of using a central store such as Elasticsearch is the ability to aggregate the logs from all your apps in one place and analyze them together. You can add the Elasticsearch.Extensions.Logging provider to your app in the same way as you added the file sink in section 26.3.

NOTE Elasticsearch is a REST-based search engine that's often used for aggregating logs. You can find out more at https://www.elastic.co/elasticsearch.

Elasticsearch is a powerful production-scale engine for storing your logs, but setting it up and running it in production isn't easy. Even after you've got it up and running, there's a somewhat steep learning curve associated with the query syntax. If you're interested in something more user-friendly for your structured logging needs, Seq (https://getseq.net) is a great option. In the next section I'll show you how adding Seq as a structured logging provider makes analyzing your logs that much easier.

26.5.1 Adding a structured logging provider to your app

To demonstrate the advantages of structured logging, in this section you'll configure an app to write logs to Seq. You'll see that the configuration is